

• A 5-PAGE PORTFOLIO • CONCEPT SAMPLES ONLY

AI-Assisted YouTube Thumbnail Design Portfolio.

PREPARED BY EMMANUEL UZZIEL MALOLOS

SHORT PROFILE

I design YouTube thumbnails with an AI-assisted workflow — moving fast from a video idea to a clean, scroll-stopping image. I focus on a clear subject, strong emotion, and short, readable text that holds up at mobile size. I am comfortable iterating on prompts, cleaning up common AI issues, and shipping revisions quickly.

RELEVANT SKILLS

AI prompt design & iteration
Visual concept development
Photo editing & compositing
Cleaning up AI artifacts
Typography for thumbnails
Fast revision turnaround

DESIGN FOCUS

Clarity within one second
Mobile-first readability
High contrast composition
Emotion & curiosity hooks
Clean, on-brand styling
Consistent quality checks

§ 02 — PROCESS

How I move from a video idea to a finished thumbnail.

A repeatable six-step process I use on every concept. It keeps the visual hook clear, the AI generation focused, and revisions fast.

01^{STEP}

Understand the video

Read the title, hook, and key moments. Decide the single idea the thumbnail must communicate at a glance.

INPUTS • TITLE • HOOK •
AUDIENCE

02^{STEP}

Create visual concepts

Sketch 2–3 directions in plain words. Lock the subject, emotion, layout, and where the text will sit.

OUTPUTS • CONCEPTS • TEXT
ZONE

03^{STEP}

Generate AI visuals

Write a clear, specific prompt for each direction. Iterate on subject, lighting, framing, and mood until usable.

TOOLS • CHATGPT • MIDJOURNEY
• SDXL

04^{STEP}

Edit & composite

Clean up artifacts, fix hands and edges, color-grade, layer text, and tune contrast for a strong visual hook.

TOOLS • PHOTOSHOP • FIGMA •
CANVA

05^{STEP}

Thumbnail quality check

Test at small size, on a busy YouTube grid, and against the title. Confirm subject reads in under one second.

CHECKS • MOBILE • GRID •
CONTRAST

06^{STEP}

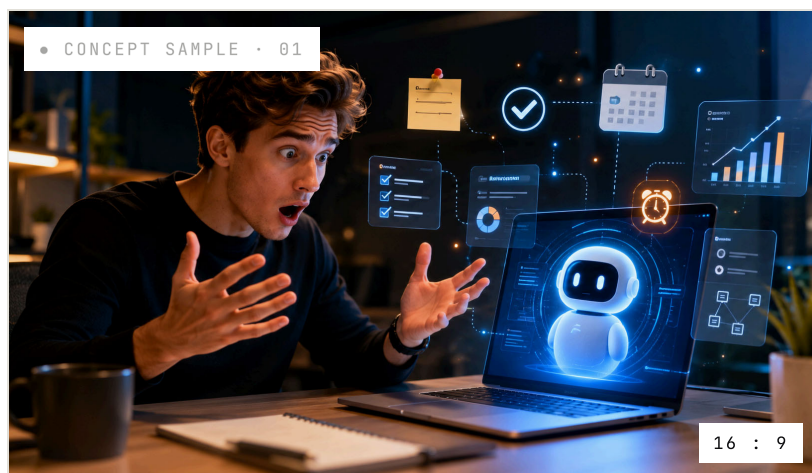
Revise quickly

Take feedback in plain notes. Swap subjects, retext, recompose, or regenerate fast — usually same-day turnaround.

TURNAROUND • SAME-DAY
REVISIONS

S 03 — SAMPLES

Three concept thumbnails across niches.



SAMPLE 01 • BUSINESS / AI

CHATGPT • MIDJOURNEY • PHOTOSHOP

“I Replaced My Assistant With AI for 7 Days”

GOAL Stop the scroll with a clear surprise reaction tied to AI productivity.

PROMPT Surprised founder reacting to a glowing AI assistant; modern desk, dramatic light, clean left text zone for bold “AI DID IT?” .



SAMPLE 02 • FINANCE / WARNING

MIDJOURNEY • PHOTOSHOP • FIGMA

“Most People Lose Money Because of This Mistake”

GOAL Use emotion and a clear red warning tone to spark curiosity.

PROMPT Worried person holding phone; dramatic red falling chart, dark background, rim light, space for bold “DON’T DO THIS” .



SAMPLE 03 • SELF-IMPROVEMENT

CHATGPT • MIDJOURNEY • PHOTOSHOP

“How I Fixed My Daily Routine With One Simple System”

GOAL Promise a practical fix with a one-glance transformation.

PROMPT Split-screen before/after desk; tired man left, focused calm subject right, soft daylight, text “FIX YOUR DAY” bridging the split.

LABEL

ALL THREE SAMPLES ABOVE ARE CONCEPT SAMPLES CREATED TO DEMONSTRATE AN AI-ASSISTED THUMBNAIL WORKFLOW. NO REAL CLIENT WORK OR METRICS ARE CLAIMED.

The 12-point check I run before every thumbnail ships.

S 04 - QUALITY CHECKLIST

Quick, practical, and the same on every project. If a thumbnail fails any of these, I revise before sending.

☒ Clear subject within 1 second 01	☒ Mobile readability 02
☒ Short, large text 03	☒ Strong emotion or curiosity 04
☒ Clean background 05	☒ High contrast 06
☒ No distorted hands, faces, or objects 07	☒ No unwanted AI text, logos, or watermarks 08
☒ Matches the video topic 09	☒ Strong visual hook 10
☒ Not overcrowded 11	☒ Ready for upload 12

A thumbnail should pass **all 12** checks before it ever leaves the workspace.

This is the same checklist I would apply to client work. It keeps the AI generation honest and stops common errors — distorted hands, weird text, busy backgrounds — from slipping through to the upload.

Turning a vague prompt into a usable one.

A short example of how I rewrite a thin prompt so the AI produces a thumbnail-ready image on the first or second pass.

Before

• VAGUE PROMPT

“Make a YouTube thumbnail about AI saving time.”

WHY THIS FAILS

It gives the AI no subject, no emotion, no setting, no framing, and no quality rules. The result will likely be generic, unfocused, and not usable as a thumbnail — usually with cluttered text, weak composition, and no space reserved for the headline.

NO SUBJECT
NO SETTING

NO EMOTION
NO COMPOSITION

After

• IMPROVED PROMPT

Create a high-CTR YouTube thumbnail image showing a busy online business owner looking shocked as an AI assistant completes tasks on a glowing laptop screen. Show floating icons for email, calendar, spreadsheets, and customer messages around the laptop. Use a clean modern desk setup, dramatic lighting, strong contrast, expressive face, and a clear central subject. Leave space on the left side for large thumbnail text. Professional YouTube thumbnail style, no readable text, no logo, no watermark, no distorted hands, no cluttered background.

WHY THIS WORKS

It gives the AI a clear subject, an emotion, a setting, a composition with reserved text space, and explicit quality requirements. That combination is what produces a usable, on-brief thumbnail in one or two passes instead of ten.

CLEAR SUBJECT STRONG EMOTION
DEFINED SETTING COMPOSITION RULES
RESERVED TEXT ZONE QUALITY GUARDRAILS

Open to **AI-focused thumbnail design work** — fast revisions, clean concepts, and a steady quality bar on every upload.

Emmanuel Uzziel Malolos
FREELANCE • AI-ASSISTED THUMBNAIL DESIGN
PORTFOLIO • 2026 EDITION